CDs: How to Burn them & how it works

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What is a CD?

- Compact Discs (CDs) are discs that could be used to store media like music. The discs is read using reflected laser light

The Beginnings of CDs

- The first prototypes of CDs were released in Japan in 1979, but was released to the public in 1982 by Philips and Sony.
- After the release CDs became more popular than vinyls and cassette tapes.
- The first two albums to be released on CDs were *The Visitors* by Abba in 1981 and *52nd Street* by Billy Joel in 1982.

The Different Types of CDs

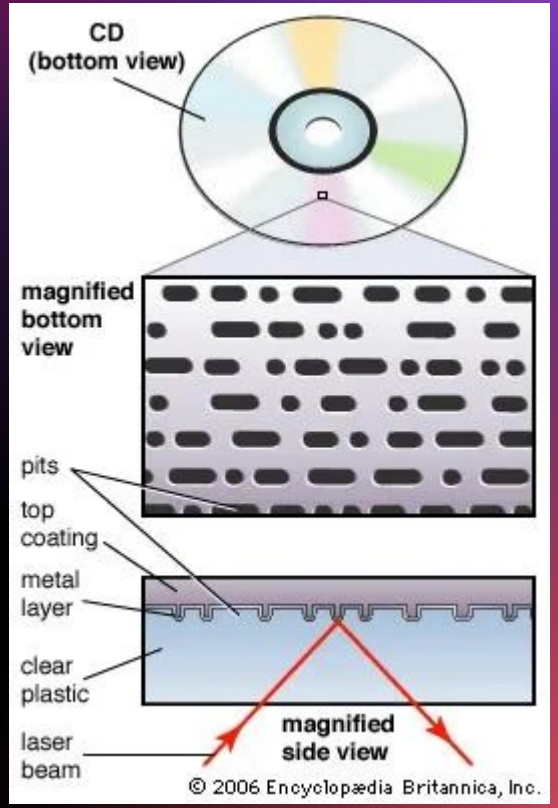
There are different types of CDs that are made to store different types of data.These are just the most used ones.

- Audio CD (CD-DA)
- CD-ROM (Compact Disc Read-Only Memory)
- CD-R (Compact Disc-Recordable)
- CD-RW (Compact Disc ReWritable)

How Do CDs Work?

There are tiny pits on CDs that a laser uses to read the data. When put into a device the laser reflections differently when going over the land and the pits. The pits and the land are binary codes that produce sound.

There is three different layers to a CD:
- A thick plastic layer
- The aluminum layer
- A protective layer



How Companies Make CDs

- They make metal molds of the pits and lands of the album
- They fill the mold with melted plastic and make sure it is pressed into the mold.
- Then they put the reflective aluminum on top and a protective plastic over it.

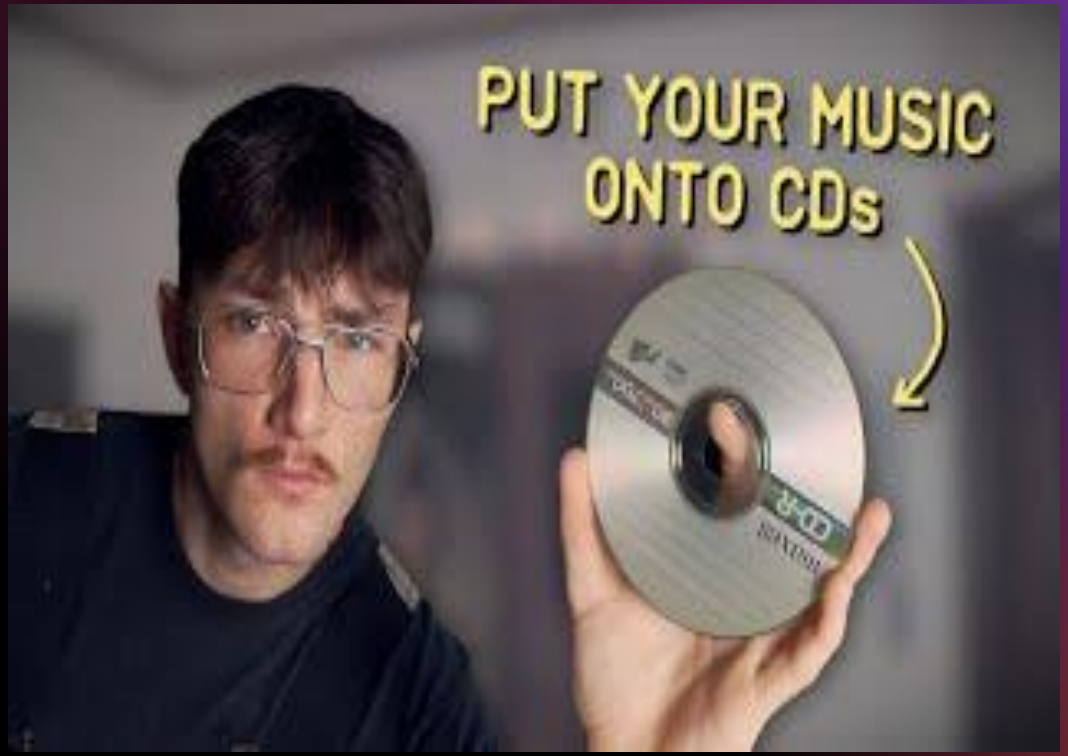
The Material Needed

- CDs that have not been burned yet
- A CD burner
- Music that you want on the CD
- A CD burner program
- A case or holder of any kind so the CD does not get scratched

Burning CDs at Home

Put an Unused CD into your computer's drive. If the computer does not have one you can use an external CD burner Use the media player or a CD burner program to upload the files. Once everything is uploaded you click burn.

Video Explanation



How CDs Are Used Now

- CDs are not as popular as they were when they first came out.
- People still make CDs for fun and to gift to other people.
- Some artists still make CDs for their albums and people still like to collect them.
- Places like Barnes and Noble, thrift stores, and vintage music stores sell new and old CDs.

Resources

History of the CD: 40 years of the compact disc
What are the different CD types?
Canon Science Lab CDs and DVDs
How It's Made: Compact Discs
Burn and rip CDs

THANK YOU